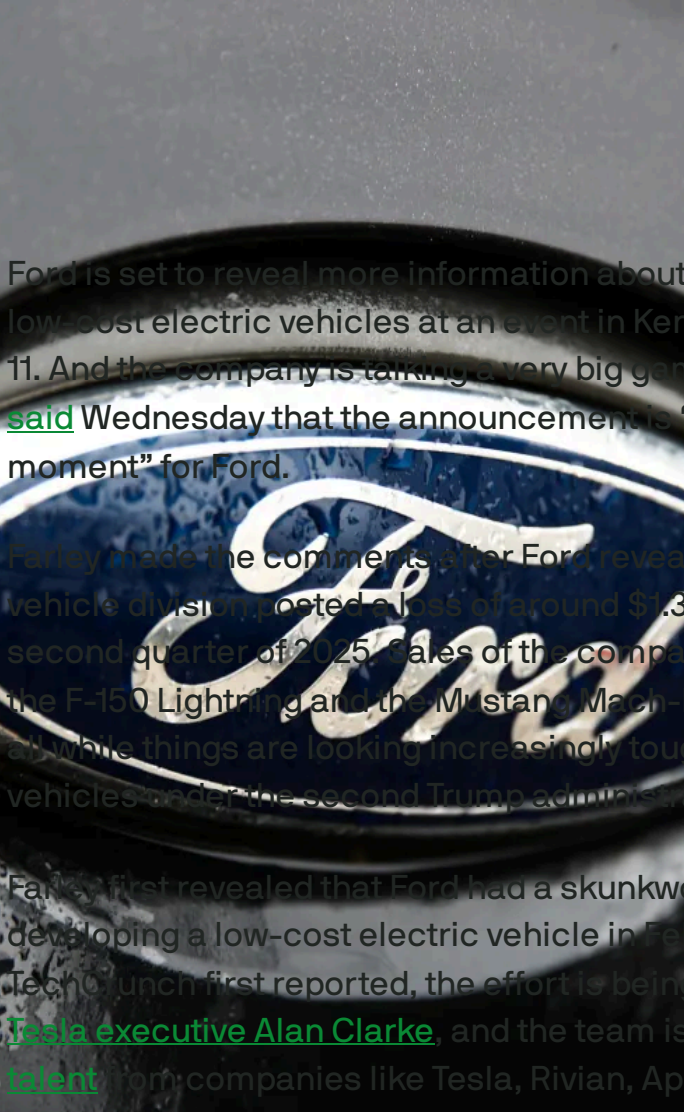




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Ford to reveal more about
its new low-cost electric
vehicles on August 11



Ford is set to reveal more information about its upcoming low-cost electric vehicles at an event in Kentucky on August 11. And the company is talking a very big game: CEO Jim Farley [said](#) Wednesday that the announcement is “a Model T moment” for Ford.

Farley made the comments after Ford revealed its electric vehicle division posted a loss of around \$1.3 billion in the second quarter of 2025. Sales of the company’s top two EVs, the F-150 Lightning and the Mustang Mach-E, are declining, all while things are looking increasingly tough for electric vehicles under the second Trump administration.

Farley first revealed that Ford had a skunkworks team developing a low-cost electric vehicle in February 2024. As [TechCrunch](#) first reported, the effort is being led by [former Tesla executive Alan Clarke](#), and the team is [brimming with talent](#) from companies like Tesla, Rivian, Apple, and Lucid Motors.

IMAGE CREDITS: JAKUB PORZYCKI / GETTY IMAGES

The company has been deliberately vague about any specifics, but has admitted that the first vehicle to be built on this new low-cost platform [will be a mid-size pickup truck](#) set for release in 2027. Ford has said it will build “multiple vehicle styles — for both retail and commercial customers” on the platform, and that these vehicles will feature “personalized digital experiences.”

Cheaper models could help Ford, but 2027 is still a long way out.

While there are basically no mass-market electric vehicles available in the U.S. at or under \$30,000, that likely won’t be the case when Ford’s secretive EVs hit the market in two years. Tesla has said it will start selling a stripped-down (and possibly smaller) Model Y SUV later this year. General Motors is [bringing back the Chevy Bolt next year](#). And Jeff Bezos-backed startup Slate Auto is putting its own [low-cost electric pickup on sale as early as late 2026](#).

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IMAGE CREDITS: FORD

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Ford says a pickup truck will be the first EV built on its low-cost platform

Sean O'Kane — 5:27 AM PDT · August 21, 2024

The first vehicle that will be built on the low-cost EV platform Ford’s been [developing in secret](#) will be a mid-size pickup

due out in 2027, the automaker announced Wednesday morning.

The news comes as part of a [much larger rewriting](#) of Ford’s electrification plans. The company is abandoning a plan to make an all-electric three-row SUV, opting instead to power those forthcoming vehicles with hybrid powertrains. A next-generation full-size electric pickup — the follow-up to the F-150 Lightning [codenamed](#) “T3” — is now expected to launch in 2027, not 2025. These changes may cost Ford as much as \$1.9 billion, the company said Wednesday.

The changes to Ford’s plans also come at a time when many major automakers are curbing their all-electric ambitions. General Motors and Honda [abandoned](#) a plan to co-develop affordable EVs last year. GM itself has [announced](#) a similar prioritization of hybrids in the near-term, and VW of America recently [said](#) that a “balanced approach is the best way.”

Ford is not the only company attempting to drive down the entry-level cost of its EVs. But the decision to build a pickup truck on the low-cost EV platform sets up Ford to differentiate itself from market-leader Tesla, which is focusing more on developing Elon Musk’s long-promised “robotaxi” as well as stripped-down versions of its Model Y SUV and Model 3 sedan.

CEO Jim Farley first revealed the existence of the “skunkworks” team building the low-cost platform in [February](#). It was created in 2022 and is currently headed up by former Tesla exec Alan Clarke, with a main office in Irvine, California. The project got a [boost](#) of talent in late 2023 when Ford acquired EV charging startup Auto Motive Power. But the automaker has since filled out the team of around 300 with dozens of workers from Rivian, Tesla and even around 10 from the recently disbanded electric/autonomous vehicle team inside Apple, as TechCrunch [first reported in June](#).

Ford says the low-cost pickup truck will “cater to customers who want more for their money — more range, more utility, more usability.” The company still plans to use the platform it’s developing to power “multiple vehicle styles — for both retail and commercial customers,” Ford said Wednesday. The company added that the “personalized digital experiences” it will build into these vehicles will help improve Ford’s “mix of sticky, profitable revenue over time.”

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Farley told TechCrunch in June that Ford was still deciding whether to take the technology and supply chain work the skunkworks team had developed and apply it across all the company's models, or focus on a few vehicles tied to this specific platform. "I can't tell you the outcome of that yet, because we're in the midst of it. I will tell you that they've done a great job, and the approach is distinctly different than our first generation of products," he said.

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As for the other vehicle Ford changed its plans for, the company says delaying the large pickup truck to 2027 will make it possible to "utilize lower-cost battery technology" and take advantage of other unspecified "cost breakthroughs." Ford says shifting the three-row SUVs to hybrid powertrains will allow the company to offer "breakthrough efficiency, performance benefits and emissions reductions versus pure gas vehicles and extend the range of the vehicle on road trips relative to pure electric vehicles."

Ford has some reason to think hybrid sales might fare better over the next few years. Farley told TechCrunch in June that Ford's F-150 sales this year have been about 25% hybrid powertrain. "We did not expect that," he said. Sales of the company's compact pickup truck, the Maverick, have been closer to 70% hybrid in 2024.

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Here are the 5 EVs that qualify for the full federal tax credit in 2024

Sean O'Kane — 8:09 AM PST · January 2, 2024

IMAGE CREDITS: SHEN CHUNCHEN/VCG / GETTY IMAGES

The U.S. government has revealed the [list](#) of electric vehicles that qualify for the full federal tax credit under [the newer, more stringent guidelines](#), and you can count them on one hand. General Motors' outgoing Chevy Bolt, plus certain variants of the Ford F-150 Lightning and Tesla's Model 3, Model Y and Model X are now the only EVs that are eligible for the \$7,500 rebate.

Beyond that, certain variants of Rivian's R1S and R1T, plus a handful of plug-in hybrids, qualify for \$3,750. Chrysler's Pacifica plug-in hybrid was able to stay eligible for the full credit. Otherwise, that's all.

Until this list was published Monday, the new requirements had many people scratching their heads about what, exactly, would qualify. Even Tesla admitted in its own way [that it wasn't exactly sure](#).

The reason the list is so anemic is because lawmakers are [trying to force the EV supply chain to shift](#) — or at least diversify away — from China to North America in the long run. In the short term, that means automakers who rely heavily on Chinese suppliers, specifically for battery materials and components, are losing eligibility. This is on top of a few other baked-in restrictions, like the fact that the vehicles must be built in North America, and must retail for less than either \$55,000 or \$80,000, depending on vehicle type.

While it will be harder to find a vehicle that qualifies for the federal EV tax credit, the credit itself is much better for consumers in two key ways. First, the credit is now applied when buying the car, meaning you won't have to wait to claim it on your tax returns.

Second, buyers no longer have to have a tax liability equal to or greater than the amount of the credit — a rule that previously kept a lot of buyers from accessing the credit in the first place. (That said, buyers still have to have certain adjusted gross income to qualify. Here's [a list of FAQs from the IRS](#).)

Some automakers, like GM, have said they are working on replacing components that are disqualifying their EVs from the credit, so the list could grow as the year goes on. A slew of automakers and suppliers are [rushing to build new factories](#)



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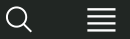


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Tesla Cybertruck pushes past Ford Mach-E to become third best-selling EV in America

Sean O'Kane — 2:21 PM PDT · October 23, 2024

Tesla's Cybertruck was the third best-selling electric vehicle in the United States in the third quarter, beating out every other EV not made by Tesla. The only two vehicles that sold better were the Model 3 sedan and Model Y SUV.

IMAGE CREDITS: TESLA

The polarizing truck notched this achievement despite selling at its most expensive trim model in the early going. It's also a sign of just how much trouble major automakers like Ford and General Motors have run into in finding customers for their own EVs.

Automotive research firm Kelley Blue Book pegged Tesla's Cybertruck sales as third-best [last week](#), notching over 16,000 sales.

Ford only sold around 7,000 F-150 Lightnings in the third quarter, and just over 13,000 Mustang Mach-E SUVs, according to [sales data](#) from the automaker. GM has seemingly found some early success with its new Blazer and Equinox EVs, but still only sold around [32,000 electric vehicles total](#) last quarter. Rivian only delivered around 3,800 of its own electric pickup.

Tesla confirmed the third-best accomplishment Wednesday when it released [its financial results for the third quarter](#). Tesla also noted that the Cybertruck generated a positive



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gross margin — a measure of profitability that is calculated by subtracting the cost of goods sold from revenue.

Tesla also revealed it generated \$25.2 billion in sales during the quarter and notched a \$2.2 billion profit. Tesla's profit was boosted by \$739 million in sales of regulatory credits to other automakers — the second-highest amount it's ever sold in a quarter, behind the second quarter of this year when it sold \$890 million worth. Tesla said its profits were also boosted by the fact that it started shipping its Actually Smart Summon feature and its Full Self-Driving (Supervised) software to Cybertruck owners, which allowed the company to recognize some of the money owners paid up front as revenue.

Tesla's relentless cost-cutting also plays into its profit figure. Tesla said in the [shareholder letter](#) that the cost of goods sold per vehicle is down to \$35,100.

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Those Q3 figures helped push Tesla’s stock price up more than 9% in after-hours trading.

Cost-cutting isn’t helping every part of the business, though. Tesla reported a 20% year-over-year growth in Supercharger stations, its slowest growth figure in years. This comes after Tesla gutted — and then started rehiring some of — its Supercharger team earlier this year as part of a massive company-wide layoff.

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